

Topic 10: Language, thought and communication – How do you communicate with others?

Subject content	What students need to learn:
10.1 Language, thought and communication	10.1.1 Understand the possible relationship between language and thought, including strengths and weaknesses of each theory: a. Piaget's (1950) explanation that representational thinking precedes language b. Vygotsky's (1981) explanation that language and thinking are separate; to include c. pre-linguistic thought d. pre-intellectual language
	10.1.2 Understand how thought and language structures affect views of the world, including strengths and weaknesses of each theory: a. linguistic relativism b. linguistic determinism
	10.1.3 Understand how communication is different in humans to animals, including: a. Aitchison (1983) criteria of language features b. similarities and differences between humans and animal communication
	10.1.4 Understand examples of non-verbal communication, including: a. facial expressions b. eye contact c. body language, to include (i) postures (ii) gestures d. personal space, to include (i) proxemics (ii) cultural differences in non-verbal communication
	10.1.5 Understand explanations of non-verbal communication, including Darwin's (1872) theory of evolution